Community Water Quality Monitoring Procedure

Technically edited clean copy. Human approval required.

Purpose: This procedure explains how field teams collect and record drinking water samples so that results are reliable and traceable to the correct site.

Scope: It applies to routine samples collected from reservoirs, treatment outlets, and public taps. The procedure does not cover emergency chemical spills or laboratory instrument calibration.

Responsibilities: The team leader checks that each technician has PBT, clean sample bottles, and a calibrated meter. Technicians are responsible for completing the Chain of Custody Form QMS-07 and reporting unsafe conditions.

Procedure: Before collecting a sample, allow the tap to run for 2 minutes. Rinse the probe with clean water, but do not rinse a sterile microbiological bottle. Record pH and turbidity in NTU at the site. Samples must be placed in a cooler between 2 and 8 degrees Celsius.

Data recording: Write the site code, date, time, and sampler initials on both the bottle and QMS-07. Corrections must be made with a single line through the error; correction fluid is not allowed. The reason for any missing reading must be stated.

Escalation: If pH is below 6.5 or above 9.5, or turbidity is higher than 1 NTU, phone the team leader immediately. Do not tell the community that the water is safe or unsafe until the authorised official has reviewed the result.